

Dustin Fichmann

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Education

Columbia University

New York, NY, USA

M.A. IN ECONOMICS

Sept. 2021 – Dec. 2022

- GPA: 3.81/4.00
- Relevant Coursework: Mathematical Methods for Economists (Measure Theory, Real Analysis, Dynamic Optimization); Microeconomic Analysis I & II; Macroeconomic Analysis I & II; Econometrics I & II; Advanced Econometrics.

Bates College

Lewiston, ME, USA

B.A. IN MATHEMATICS AND ECONOMICS (DOUBLE MAJOR)

Aug. 2017 – May 2021

- GPA: 3.98/4.00; Major GPA: 4.00/4.00; Summa Cum Laude
- Relevant Coursework: Real Analysis; Linear Algebra; Probability; Complex Analysis; Abstract Algebra; Multivariable Calculus; Statistics; Big Data and Machine Learning; Urban Economics.

University of Oxford

Oxford, UK

VISITING STUDENT, ECONOMICS

Oct. 2019 – Jun. 2020

- Relevant Coursework: Behavioral Economics; Labor Economics.

Honors and Fellowships

2021 **Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa, Sigma Xi, Dean's List**, Bates College

2018 **Dana Scholar Award — Academic performance and leadership potential**, Bates College

2017–2021 **Shelby Davis Scholarship — \$10,000 per year for 4 years**, Bates College / UWC

2020 **Book Prizes for Excellence in Behavioral and Labor Economics**, University of Oxford

Research Experience

Harvard University, Department of Economics

Cambridge, MA

PRE-DOCTORAL FELLOW IN BEHAVIORAL-ECONOMIC THEORY (WITH PROF. MATTHEW RABIN)

Jul. 2025 – Present

- Drew out the theoretical implications of recent models that attempt to improve the psychological realism of economics.
- Expectations-Based Reference Dependence (EBRD): Worked out the behavior of an agent with EBRD when facing price and health uncertainty over finite and infinite periods. Created visualizations to showcase how the optimal plan can be inconsistent and how to find the optimal consistent plan in complex environments.
- Belief Updating: Created a comprehensive list of features for updating models (Confirmation Bias, Base-Rate Neglect, Law of Small Numbers, Naive Herding). Formalized mathematical definitions of features.

Harvard Business School

Boston, MA

PRE-DOCTORAL FELLOW IN BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS (WITH PROF. THOMAS GRAEBER)

Jun. 2024 – Jul. 2025

- Designed and implemented weekly Prolific experiments.
- Assisted with the following research projects:
 - Graeber, Thomas; Roth, Christopher; and Sammon, Marco. “Coarse Categories in a Complex World.” *CESifo Working Paper No. 12032*, July 2025.
 - Gabaix, Xavier and Thomas Graeber. “The Complexity of Economic Decisions.” *NBER Working Paper No. 33109*, November 2024.
 - Ongoing project with Benjamin Enke on cognitive reference dependence that analyzes when people exhibit comparison versus contrast effects.
 - Ongoing project using LLM agents to estimate conversion metrics for digital assets.

World Data Lab

DATA SCIENTIST (WITH DR HOMI KHARAS)

- Developed expenditure and SDG performance models using machine learning techniques.

Vienna, Austria

Aug. 2023 – May 2024

Columbia University – Program for Economic Research

RESEARCH ASSISTANT (WITH PROFS. BRENDAN O’FLAHERTY)

- Applied causal forest algorithm to analyze racial disparities in police killings of civilians.

New York, NY

May 2022 – Apr. 2023

Teaching

2024 – 2025	Harvard Business School - MBA Negotiations (Prof. Thomas Graeber) , Assisted with Teaching	Boston, MA
2018 – 2019	Bates College - Mathematics and Statistics Workshop , Tutor for Calculus II, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus	Lewiston, ME
2018	Lewiston High School , Math Tutor	Lewiston, ME

Presentations

2022	Research Paper Presentation - Columbia University , Perceptions of Crime and the Gender Commuting Gap	New York, NY
2021	Mount David Summit - Bates College , Collision Algorithms and Pollard’s ρ Method	Lewiston, ME

Independent Research Projects

Columbia University

New York, NY

MASTER’S THESIS: PERCEPTIONS OF CRIME AND THE GENDER COMMUTING GAP

Sept. 2022 – Dec. 2022

- Advisor: Prof. Brendan O’Flaherty.
- Research Question: What is the relationship between people’s perception of crime and the gender commuting time gap?
- Data: Custom dataset matching ACS Public Use Microdata Sample by city with Uniform Crime Reporting data from the FBI.
- Method: Heckman selection and probit models.

Bates College

Lewiston, ME

SENIOR THESIS: WHAT ROLE DOES INCOME PLAY IN URBAN HOUSING CHOICES?

Jan. 2021 – May 2021

- Advisor: Prof. Nathan Tefft.
- Research Question: Do higher income households have longer commutes when fixing commuting method?
- Data: ACS Public Use Microdata Sample.
- Method: Fixed-effect model.

References

Professor Matthew Rabin — Harvard University Department of Economics and Business School. Email: matthewrabin@fas.harvard.edu

Professor Thomas Graeber — University of Zurich; Formerly Harvard Business School (2020-2025). Email: thomas.graeber@econ.uzh.ch

Professor Brendan O’Flaherty — Columbia University. Email: bo2@columbia.edu

Languages & Skills

Languages: English (native); German (native); Spanish (intermediate); French, Italian & Mandarin (elementary).

Programming: Stata; R; Python; Matlab; JavaScript; HTML; $\text{\LaTeX}$; Qualtrics.